Overcommitment to the Bit: How Catra Became an Ordained Minister

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58805881.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Catra & Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Crack Treated Seriously, Fluff and Crack, Humor, Basically finished honestly, Catra's had therapy and is doing her best, sometimes being a best friend means being a weirdo, ordained minister Catra, Pet Wedding (literal pets), Animal Death (non graphic), technology death (non graphic), semi-completed but also abandoned fic

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Part 4 of Making Light Hope Proud (WiPs I Won't Continue)

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by Nny11

Summary

You know how sometimes you hear about some genuinely bizarre and weird thing someone does on the side, but the steps there seemed pretty logical?

Welcome to how Catra accidentally became a legally ordained minister thanks to anxiety, spite, and over committing to the bit!

Notes

For those who don't know this series is for fics that are unfinshed but I wanted to share what I did have, and of the bunch this one is the most completed fic. I could've cut the end scene and it would've worked on it's own but I really wanted it to continue into the human realm.

See the end of the work for more notes

It started, as so many things in her life did, as a small but not completely bizarre occurrence.

Catra and Scorpia were walking together. It was early in the morning, still dark even as the first pink rays started to paint the sky, and the sidewalk was covered in small puddles from the rain. It had been too cold yet for many critters to come out overnight, and Catra was suffering through the chill when there was a sudden crunching sound.

She would've ignored it, except Scorpia froze, eyes watering up as she whispered, "Oh no!"

To Catra, the snail's death was a welcome heralding of warmth to come. Snails were out so it must be getting more pleasant outside; huzzah and all that.

To Scorpia it was an act of murder.

After five minutes had elapsed trying to comfort her crying friend, Catra was getting desperate. She wasn't great at comforting people, high emotions over bullshit pissed her off, and soon other people would witness her giant friend kneeling on the wet ground holding the mutilated remains of a snail.

"Oh my god," Catra wheezed, doing her best to not snap and make things worse, "Would you feel better if we buried the stupid thing?"

It was a mean comment, not actually a suggestion, but all that flew over Scorpia's head. She nodded miserably and Catra had been forced to dig a hole in the little strip of mud between them and the road. Scorpia gently lowered the snail and patted the mud over top, then grabbed a few pebbles to make a little headstone. Despite being the one who wanted the funeral, Scorpia was too choked up to say anything and Catra was desperate to end this whole situation.

So there they stood, two full grown adults with hands respectfully clasped in front of themselves at five in the goddamned morning, covered in rainwater and some mud while Scorpia made pleading eyes at her through the tears.

And Catra gave up. "Today we return this snail-"

"Shellby." Scorpia choked out.

"...this snail, Shellby, to the earth. Gone too soon but now at peace, we will never forget her. Now can we please get a move on?"

It was a moment of anger and weakness that made Catra do something monumentally stupid in the name of being a better friend. Sure, Scorpia was bound to tell people about it, probably crying again with guilt or with fondness, but no one else had actually *seen* it and that was good enough.

That just *really* should've been it.

It was a few months later when Scorpia, dancing on her tippy toes, came out to the front of the store with tears in her eyes because their mouse trap had worked.

"Oh thank fuck, that better be the only one!" Catra grumbled on seeing the dead mouse.

"Catra…"

"What?"

"Can, oh gosh, can we please bury her too? I know you said no more after Shellby, but poor little Harriet! She was just living her life, and we just killed her for trying to survive! I can't do this again Wild Cat, I'm sensitive!"

Somehow, Catra found herself out behind the store where Entrapta dutifully dug a hole and Scorpia laid the mouse carefully down into it. Entrapta stared without blinking, clearly trying to

memorize and parse through what was happening in her own way while Scorpia burst into tears again.

Catra must have looked particularly desperate, because Entrapta snapped out of it long enough to slap Scorpia's back while saying, "There, there!"

She saw someone peak around the corner to see what was happening and that was the last straw this time. A little speech was needed the first time, and if it sped this up she could die happy herself. "We are gathered here today to say goodbye to Harriet. She was just a dude being a guy, and her life was cut tragically short. Ashes to ashes, dust to dust. Can we **please** go back inside now?"

And, somehow, this made Catra the designated speaker at every little funeral.

And there were a LOT of little funerals.

There was Peter the spider that Catra had killed (spiders outside equal totally chill, spiders inside equal murder) in panic right as Scorpia arrived with a cup to take it outside. Then Scorpia asked for a fucking blessing over her mosquito zapper out of a sense of deep guilt and also the knowledge that Catra drew the line at multiple funerals for the blood suckers. Entrapta came forward with a completely melted and worthless bit of tech (a CPU? Hard drive? Catra didn't know nor care) that she wanted "buried" to commemorate their hard work. The fish Scorpia won at the fair was next, then Entrapta's cheap princess tea set that was warped beyond use in the dishwasher. She barely even thought about how fucked up this all was when they'd found the headless pigeon in the parking lot, already digging into her resolve to get it over with and only afterward considered that was in broad daylight in front of the shop.

Catra begrudgingly did them all, reaching to remember every movie funeral she'd ever seen to copy the words from.

The messed up thing was that by the time a few years had passed, Catra found the whole thing weirdly funny. Like she was starting to own it for herself kind of funny.

She dressed as a priest for halloween, and refused to explain herself to anyone. She actually looked up eulogies to craft something better. It was her funny thing now and she felt a drive to up the ante. This was her stupid life, being a dummy who spoke at funerals for anything but other human beings. Entrapta liked the ritual of it, having never known what to do with ruined tech (although to be fair they never buried her things, usually recycling or trashing politely) it gave Entrapta a way to thank each piece for the work they did for her. Scorpia just felt better after a good cry and also felt better for having done something nice for the creatures they found. Catra was just an idiot for playing along, but she liked making her friends happy and afterwards she could get a little chuckle out of it. So she owned it, quietly and secretly for her personal amusement.

It was during a hiking trip with Glimmer, Bow, and Adora that things got… well-

"Oohhhh, oh no! Oh you poor baby!" Scorpia half wailed, making Catra's blood run cold.

She couldn't deny her friends a funeral now, not after literal years of capitulating, but good god she did not want to do this in front of their other friends *who didn't know about this* . So even though she could tell she was pale as hell, Catra trudged forward like a condemned man. Sure enough, there was a small lizard that clearly had been dead for a while, curled up and semi-dried out.

"I got it!" Entrapta called, snapping on a pair of latex gloves to carefully handle the unknown wildlife while Scorpia dug a small hole.

"What's going on?" Adora tried to whisper but failed miserably.

Catra sighed, “We’re holding a funeral for the lizard Scorpia found.”

“That is so sweet!” Bow quietly gushed as he started to tear up.

“Yeah it’s… something alright.” Catra groaned before seeing the procession was ready and waiting.

She quietly stepped over and could feel whatever coolness credibility she had vanishing in front of her eyes. She tilted her head towards Scorpia, forcing herself to get in character as her best friend chose a name and finally whimpered, “Elizabeth.” Catra had made this mistake and was all about owning up to that shit nowadays. Sometimes owning something and being nicer sucked.

The best friend squad all but scrambled to find places so they formed a little circle around the grave. Which was really sweet honestly, they had no idea what was happening but wanted to help. Also it was terrible because now they were front and center for this.

God, Catra was going to **die** of embarrassment.

“Thank you for taking the time to pause with us as we honor the memory of Elizabeth,” Catra started, closing her eyes to ignore, very specifically, Glimmer’s bug eyed reaction. “Elizabeth lived her life to its fullest, enjoying the quiet of the forest and the bounty of the trees.” Did lizards even eat leaves or fruits? Ah well. “We all will pass when our time comes, but those who are left behind can celebrate our legacy. So we celebrate our dearly departed Elizabeth, we remember how happy she was to live somewhere so beautiful, and we keep her in our hearts. Thank you.”

Scorpia was full out blubbering by the time Catra finished, Entrapta and Bow both giving her side hugs as Scorpia wiped her tears away. Adora was digging through her backpack and triumphantly held up her disgustingly bright orange handkerchief before giving it to Scorpia to blow her nose.

Glimmer, nearly purple as she shook with repressed laughter, stared manically at Catra.

Quietly, so as not to disturb her true friends, Catra stalked over and hissed, "I hope you break a fucking rib."

She really shouldn't have been surprised when Glimmer gifted her an interfaith prayer book, cackling as Catra chased her around the park shrieking with delight, "Forgive me father, for I have sinned!"

And that should have been the end of this stupid thing but somehow wasn't.

"I know!" Scorpia squealed as she scruffled Emily behind the ears. "We should marry Emily and Melog, gosh how cute would that be? Aw! And Catra, you could be the officiant!"

"No."

"Aw, c'mon! It would be cute. You can admit it would be so cute, wouldn't it Emily? Yesh it would!"

"I don't have to admit to anything, especially when I don't agree with it."

And Melog, the traitor, stretched from his nap and walked over before jumping up onto Emily's broad back. Then curled up and went to sleep. Bastard boy. Stinky awful cat.

"AWWWWWW!!!! Wild Cat, pleeeeeaseeeee!?"

She did a little cursory looking around for wedding information, because beyond the vague notion of saying vows (whatever those actually were), something about sickness and health, and saying I do with a kiss, Catra was a little mortified to realize how little she knew about weddings. It made sense why she didn't, Weaver had not exactly been marriage material and she'd never attended one in her life. The depictions in media were usually blown out of proportion anyways and she wouldn't touch them with a ten foot

pole. But a little cursory look and research suddenly became an all consuming rabbit hole.

Catra was 53 tabs deep and currently reading line by line through a list of wedding customs by culture while occasionally returning to re-read about ghost marriage, it was 1:24 AM, and she was pretty sure she'd lost control of her own life.

"W-what are you doing?" Entrapta had yawned as she came out of her room to stare blearily at her roommate.

Catra mumbled, "Til bark do us park, is your doggy in woof with the sweetie next door?"

"...oh…kay?"

That should've snapped her out of it. She had managed to confuse and creep out Entrapta, that was a, like, a secret life achievement! Instead it made her realize she had the mother of the bride at her disposal to grill for information.

"Is Emily gonna wear a dress or something?" Catra had asked, at that point semi-delirious after being awake for over 24 hours straight. "I was thinking, like, hand-fasting but with leashes but a dress might fuck with that."

"Oh wow," Entrapta clearly thought she was whispering to herself as she walked over and gently closed Catra's laptop, "Is this how you feel when I pull all nighters? This is awful. I do not like it at all!"

It was a few days later when Scorpia's girlfriend, who had gotten locked out of her apartment and decided to terrorize Catra via garden power, had offered to take photos as the official pet photographer that Catra realized this was like, a real thing that was happening. That should've been good considering the anxiety spiral she'd taken over it and all the hours of research. But also, ugh.

"Bride and groom only. Take a photo of me at this and you die."

Perfuma, who had finished her third dandelion crown, giggled with delight as she plopped it on top of the other two Catra was already wearing. “Understood.”

After that she’d swung wildly back and forth between being excited to ham up the dumbest thing ever and considering picking up Melog to flee the country. It was during her daydream about running away to the moors to live as a shepard who would starve to death in the winter because she refused to interface with anyone else, so food ran out, heat ran out, and she grew deathly ill with no one for comfort but her cat, that Catra had had her last major revelation leading up to the “big day”. Despite the daydream, she’d been forced to admit the idea fell firmly into the excited to be a clown territory that she thought she’d outgrown after high school. And also that she maybe needed to not drink so much caffeine in the afternoon that she was required to complete some weird death day dream before realizing she was enjoying her life rather well thanks.

Unrelated probably. Don’t worry about it. The point was now that she had her opinion settled, there was a heading to follow.

It was the work of less than thirty minutes before Catra stared at her stupid little certificate, purchased for chump change without any qualification and started to laugh. She was officially an ordained minister, and that was the funniest shit in the world. She could actually legally marry people. She could request a body be released from a morgue for an actual real for people funeral. Fucking hell, she could *baptize* someone if she wanted to! Catra had only been forced to go to church until she was eight and made such a scene that Weaver was banned from bringing her back, but she could now baptize someone with nothing more than holy water and a squirt gun for flair.

The afternoon of the “wedding” Catra had arrived, a little too proudly wearing her priest costume again after shoving Melog into a harness decorated to look like a tuxedo and a small top hat he’d been a little too chill about wearing. Scorpia held onto his leash with unshed tears and two matching collars in hand while Perfuma

snapped multiple photos of Melog with her phone. When Entrapta made wide and wild eye contact with her, Catra started the wedding march and only laughed a little as her friend was all but hauled down the "aisle" by her giant dog. Emily at least responded to the command to sit once they reached the small rented trellis in the backyard.

When the music ended, Catra began.

"Welcome friends, enemies, and those yet to be determined. We are gathered here today to witness and celebrate the marriage of Emily the mastiff and Melog the stray cat. This is not the beginning of a new relationship, but an acknowledgement of the next chapter in their lives. Emily and Melog have spent years getting to know one another, fought over pet beds, shared cardboard boxes, and ate the bacon from breakfast burritos that were left on the counter *even though* certain people were told not to leave food out there. Today we will affirm this bond formally, unofficially, questionably sanctioned, and publicly in the privacy of our backyard."

Perfuma snapped a few more photos, Scorpia was beaming and cheeks flushed, Entrapta was cajoling Emily to stay seated with the clicker tool, and Melog was grooming his ass. Yeah, that fucking tracked.

"Emily and Melog will mark their transition as a couple not only celebrating the love between them, but the love between all of us. Without that love, today would be far less joyous."Catra paused for dramatic effect. "As they are both animals and cannot speak, they have opted to not give vows. As such, Melog, do you take Emily to be your unlawfully wedded wifey? To have and to sleep on, in sickness and in health, in good times and bad time, filled bowls of kibble or fruitless crying for the wet stuff at two in the morning, for as long as you both shall live?"

Catra looked down at Melog and sighed as he kept licking away, this time at his belly instead of answering just because she'd said

his name. “Dude, you look fly as fuck, pay attention. Ugh, Melog, speak.”

Melog blinked up at her, processed the command, and gave a single chirp before returning to his important work.

“Good enough for government work. Emily, do you take Melog to be your unlawfully wedded catboy husband? To have and to snuggle with, whether he hisses or purrs, playing together with your toys or Melog lording it over your head, sharing a plush bed or swapping them for as long as you both shall live?”

Entrapta immediately popped into action. “Emily, sit up!” Emily sat up on her back legs, paws in a classic begging position. “Emily say, I do!”

Catra felt the hair all over her body lift as the dog managed to bark, “Awoo wooo.” in a way that sounded like “I do”. How long had that taken to train? Wait, when did Entrapta train her to- no. Some questions were better left unanswered.

“That is freaky, never do that again. A ring, or in this case premium leather collar, is an unbroken circle that ends by being joined together. It is infinity, as is your love. As you see these collars on one another please think nothing in particular as you are animals, but we will think fondly of your commitment to this moment, yourselves, and your love. Scorpia, the collars please.”

Scorpia gave Melog’s collar to Entrapta and Emily’s collar to Catra, and after a quick moment of switching they now both sported their half white and half black collars. Perfuma took so many photos that Catra was frankly concerned that her phone wasn’t going to have any memory left in it.

“Ladies, gentlemen, and all higher life forms humoring us in attendance, we have witnessed this sealed pledge and declaration of undying love. By the authority legally vested in me by this great state, I now pronounce you, not officially but as close as you can get to officially, married. You may kiss, but please keep it PG.”

Entrapta, once again having taught last minute tricks pointed at Melog and told Emily, “Kiss! Gently! Kiss gently!”

Melog took a giant slobbery smackeroo to the face for the team, and even Catra cooed as he rubbed against Emily’s side and began to purr.

Catra was proud of herself. Had she mostly ripped the script from the first result she had in google? Yes. But she still memorized and delivered it like a pro, got to dress her boy up in silly clothes worthy of a silly man, and then they all ate cake together far away from the disgusting tuna smell of the churu treats. It was a nice afternoon with friends, and a few weeks later Scorpia had posted the “photo album” online of the wedding for everyone to enjoy. She’d even gotten a congratulations gift on becoming an official and licensed minister out of the deal.

It was a slick con and a nice time, and she hadn’t had to suffer a single insufferable “sorry daddy, i’ve been naughty” joke during it. Win-win all around.

And that REALLY should have been the end of it.

It had *seemed* like the end of it. Catra was now a certified weirdo holding animal funerals and occasionally the same for tech. Sometimes she’d be asked for a blessing and had even bought a squirt gun for the baptism requests that never arrived. A little funny ha ha that was just a normal part of her life for years without further incident.

Until the day Catra was murdered, brutally, in public.

“Catra could perform the ceremony for us,” Perfuma added, her loving smile turning just a hair evil, “since she’s an ordained minister that would count.”

Scorpia squealed, sweeping her fiance into another kiss as Catra tried to not lose it laughing. Perfuma was a bitch in the best way possible, and Catra could 100% respect that. That was a perfect

long con if she'd ever seen one, and sure the result was she was just dead meat for jokes now but it was worth it.

"I'm sorry, you're a what?!" Glimmer demanded.

Catra smirked, "You didn't know? I'm an ordained and licensed minister."

"Oh my god," Glimmer wheezed, going through too many emotions to settle on one, "holy shit, you're joking. You have to be joking!"

"Nope," Catra popped the P pretty hard before putting a hand to her chest, "when in my official and legal capacity, I am heretically Father Catra."

"Jesus!"

"Cannot help you my child," Catra intoned solemnly before looking back at the happy couple. "Okay but seriously, I've never done something like this, so maybe someone with more experience?"

"No," Scorpia was deadly serious, "You are my best friend in the whole world, and I want you to be the one. Also, you do have experience!"

Catra rolled her eyes, "Fake marrying a dog and cat for the laughs does not count."

Perfuma, still in bitch mode, hopped in, "Oh don't sell yourself short! You spent *hours* crafting that ceremony, I think that counts."

Catra squeaked in embarrassment. "No- I- now hang on!"

"HOURS?! What is happening, is this a dream???" Glimmer yelped. "Is there- YOU MARRIED EMILY AND MELOG? And didn't invite me! Bitch!?"

Catra groaned as her friends quickly became her newest enemies. But she was no match for Scorpia's duel serious but puppy dog eyes and Perfuma's scary namaste motherfucker glare. "Fine! Fine, I can do it, put that shit away!"

"Yay!" The betrothed couple cheered together before whipping to face one another shouting, "Jinx! DOUBLE JINX!" And then they were kissing again.

Ugh.

"What should I wear?" Catra asked, resigned to her fate.

"You have your priestly outfit!" Scorpia smiled far too innocently for someone with bright pink lipstick stains covering her mouth.

".....the cheap halloween costume that I got on sale at a thrift store?"

"Yeah that's the one!"

Catra added *buying more official-looking clothes for ministering* to her list of unexpected expenses. "I'll find something better."

End Notes

As mentioned in the tags this fic was really almost finished, and yet, it had so much more that needed to be done. The notes at the end were sparse enough that I'm not adding a second chapter for this one, below is how the fic was going to end with Catra actually getting a bit more spiritual and continuing to somehow get tapped for anything people could possibly use her certification and experience for lol.

Please understand the best friend squad is appalled I didn't include them at the pet wedding but that's the way the cookie crumbles.

[Catra gets appropriate clothes, feels bad about her certificate, tries prayer again for the first time in forever, almost gives up on the whole thing as Perfuma and Scorpia argue over the ceremony, realizes how much public speaking she'll be doing, and finally gets the ceremony nailed down with them. Scorpia and Perfuma get married and it's soppy. Catra signs off on the certificate and realizes that this is like, legal and legit, and is very proud of herself.

Right up until everyone starts using her as their "Oh yeah I know a guy" and then she's just like, REALLY!? Which is fic end on the joke where Glimmer and Bow ask her to be their officiant, Catra demands something silly from Glimmer thinking it'll deter them, and it does not.]

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